Minutes of the Meeting of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax Held in the Council Chambers, Ajax Town Hall and Electronically on Monday, April 22, 2025

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347

Present:	Mayor	S. Collier
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		N. Henry
		L. Bower

1. Call to Order & Acknowledgement of Traditional Treaty Lands

Mayor Collier called the meeting to order at 1:04 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

3. Adoption of the Minutes

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the following minutes of previous Council meetings be adopted:

- Special Meeting of March 24, 2025;
- Regular Meeting of March 24, 2025; and
- Closed Meeting of March 24, 2025.

Recorded Vote

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

4. Question Period

Mayor Collier invited questions on agenda items from those present.

5. Delegations, Presentations, and Public Meetings

Motion to Suspend the Rules of Procedure

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the Rules of Procedure be suspended in order to hear an unscheduled delegation (agenda item 5.5).

Recorded Vote

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED
on 2/3rds

5.1 **Delegation: Community Care Durham's OneConnect Program**

James Meloche, CEO, Community Care Durham, delivered a presentation related to Community Care Durham's OneConnect Program.

Council Members asked questions related to the presentation. J. Meloche responded to questions from Council Members.

With the consent of Members present, item 9.2 was advanced in the order business

9. Business Arising from Notice of Motion

9.2 **Advocating for Provincial Support for OneConnect Senior Care**

Regional Councillor Dies and Councillor Bower introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: L. Bower

WHEREAS the Town of Ajax is facing a rapidly aging population, with individuals over 65 making up 13% of the Town's total population according to the 2021 census data, up from 7.3% in 2001;

AND WHEREAS there is no publicly funded Adult Day Program (ADP) in the Ajax, forcing residents to travel to Pickering or Whitby for ADP services, where they are facing long wait lists;

AND WHEREAS many Canadians want to age in place in their own home and community, which requires appropriate health and social supports and services to facilitate independent living;

AND WHEREAS the Ministry of Health, through its Home Care Modernization initiative, is seeking innovative in-home care delivery models;

AND WHEREAS on March 25, 2024, Ajax Council passed a resolution calling for the implementation of a Program of All-Inclusive Care for the Elderly (PACE) in the community to offer a better quality of life for residents and their caregivers while alleviating demands on hospitals & healthcare institutions;

AND WHEREAS the not-for-profit agency Community Care Durham (CCD) is a leading provider of support services in the Region, including Assisted Living, Transportation, Day Programs, Meal and Food Security, Mental Wellness, and more;

AND WHEREAS CCD is seeking Provincial and Regional support to implement an innovative new PACE program 'OneConnect', which coordinates comprehensive health and wellness services around seniors and vulnerable clients to help them and their caregivers live optimally at home, in the community;

AND WHEREAS CCD is publicly funded by the Ministry of Health and Long-Term Care through Ontario Health – East Region and requires new funding to implement OneConnect;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:

1. Ajax Council supports and endorses Community Care Durham's vision for implementing OneConnect in Ajax; and

2. Ajax Council encourages the Government of Ontario to provide the necessary funding to Community Care Durham to implement, evaluate, and scale OneConnect to meet the growing needs of our aging population; and

3. A copy of this motion be sent to the Honourable Sylvia Jones, Minister of Health, Rob Cerjanec, MPP for Ajax, John Henry, Chair of the Regional Municipality of Durham, Durham Regional Health and Social Services Committee, Durham Regional Local Housing Corporation, Ashley Manor Housing Corporation (formerly Ajax Municipal Housing Corporation), Cynthia Davis, President and CEO of Lakeridge Health, Lisa Kitchen, Director of the Durham Ontario Health Team, Matt Anderson, President & CEO of Ontario Health, and all Durham Region MPPs.

Recorded Vote

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

5. Delegations, Presentations, and Public Meetings

5.2 Delegation: Motion to Call on Federal Government to Support Sustainable Funding for PARA Marine Search and Rescue

Clint Scott, Unit Training Officer and Community Development Officer, PARA Marine Search and Rescue, presented the PARA Marine Search and Rescue Annual Update and expressed support for the motion to call on the federal government to support sustainable funding for PARA Marine Search and Rescue.

Council Members asked questions related to the presentation. C. Scott responded to questions from Council Members.

With the consent of Members present, item 9.1 was advanced in the order business.

9. Business Arising from Notice of Motion

9.1 Advocating for Sustainable Federal Funding for PARA Marine Search and Rescue

Councillor Bower and Mayor Collier introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: S. Collier

WHEREAS PARA Marine Search and Rescue (PMSAR) is a registered Canadian charity that has been operating with a dedicated team of volunteers since 1967, who have contributed thousands of hours annually to ensure the safety of individuals participating in water activities on Lake Ontario;

AND WHEREAS PMSAR annually conducts over 30 search and rescue missions in coordination with Canadian Coast Guard, from Port Credit to Port Hope. Notable rescues include the recovery of kayakers, children on floats, and searches for missing persons off the shores of Lake Ontario. The unit works alongside various other government departments including local police, fire, EMS, and Coast Guard for both Canada and the US;

AND WHEREAS PMSAR's commitment to safety, teamwork, and community has been recognized through numerous awards and recognitions;

AND WHEREAS despite its vital work, PMSAR operates with minimal federal support, relying heavily on community funding and volunteer efforts to raise funds for major capital acquisitions;

AND WHEREAS the lack of direct sustainable and predictable funding from upper-tier governments poses a significant risk to the continuity and effectiveness of PMSAR's long-term operations;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:

1. Ajax Council calls on the Federal Government to commit sustainable and predictable funding from the federal government to PARA Marine Search and Rescue to support the organization's long-term operational needs, including vessel and equipment replacement, and for the continued safety and protection of residents on Lake Ontario; and

2. Ajax Council encourages all Durham municipalities and the City of Toronto to bring forward similar motions advocating for sustainable support for PARA Marine Search and Rescue;

3. A copy of this motion be sent to the MP for Ajax; Rob Cerjanec, MPP for Ajax; Public Safety Canada; the Regional Municipality of Durham; all Durham Region lower-tier municipalities; the City of Toronto; PARA Marine Search and Rescue; all Durham Region MPs; and all Durham Region MPPs.

Recorded Vote

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

5. Delegations, Presentations, and Public Meetings

5.5 Delegation: Red Bricks Development

Tyler Hunting, Ajax resident, expressed concerns related to the Red Bricks Development.

Council Members asked questions related to the delegation. T. Hunting and Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services, responded to questions from Council Members.

Mayor Collier addressed concerns raised by the delegate.

Council Members asked further questions related to the delegation. G. Romanowski responded to questions from Council Members.

5.3 Presentation: Durham Agricultural Advisory Committee (DAAC) – Community Outreach Presentation to Council

Zac Cohoon, Durham Agricultural Advisory Committee Member, Durham Agricultural Advisory Committee, provided updates from the Durham Agricultural Advisory Committee.

Council Members asked questions related to the presentation. Z. Cohoon and Neil Guthrie, Durham Agricultural Advisory Committee Member, Durham Agricultural Advisory Committee, responded to questions from Council Members.

5.4 **Public Meeting:** **Regional Official Plan Amendment Application ROPA25-AJAX1**
Official Plan Amendment Application OPA25-A1
Zoning By-law Amendment Application Z3/25
400 & 430 Salem Road North
Pursuant to section 284.3 of the Municipal Act, 2001

Mayor Collier noted that the proposed by-laws namely, Regional Official Plan Amendment Application ROPA25-AJAX1, Official Plan Amendment Application OPA25-A1, and Zoning By-law Amendment Application Z3/25 were brought forward under the authority of Section 284.3 of the Municipal Act, 2001.

Mayor Collier declared the meeting to be a public meeting and invited comments and questions from the public.

There being no questions or comments from the public, Mayor Collier closed the public meeting.

Michael Testaguzza, Partner, The Biglieri Group, spoke on behalf of the applicant/owner. M. Testaguzza delivered a presentation related to the proposed development applications.

Mayor Collier summarized the fundamental elements of the proposed by-laws.

With the consent of Members present, item 10, namely by-law numbers 34-2025 to 36-2025 were advanced in the order business.

Council Members asked questions related to the proposed development applications and proposed by-laws. M. Testaguzza, Mayor Collier, and G. Romanowski, responded to questions from Council Members.

10. By-laws

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: L. Bower

That By-law numbers 34-2025 to 36-2025 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

Recorded Vote

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED
on 1/3rd

6. Correspondence

None.

7. Reports

7.1 Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report

7.1.1 Community Affairs & Planning Committee, April 7, 2025

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report dated April 7, 2025 be adopted.

Recorded Vote

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

7.2 **General Government Committee Report**

7.2.1 **General Government Committee, April 14, 2025**

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the General Government Committee Report dated April 14, 2025, be adopted.

Recorded Vote

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

7.3 **Departmental Reports**

7.3.1 **PSA-2025-01: 2022 – 2026 Strategic Plan (Action 26) Update**

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the 2022–2026 Strategic Plan (*Action26*) Update be received for information.

Recorded Vote

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

7.3.2 **PSA-2025-03: Electric Vehicle Charging Stations – Unbudgeted Capital Project**
Referred from the April 14, 2025 General Government Committee Meeting

1. That Council approve three unbudgeted capital projects totaling $539,400 for Electric Vehicle Charging Stations.

2. That $379,400 be allocated to the capital projects from the Capital Contingency reserve and $160,000 be allocated from grant funding.

FAILED MOTION
(no seconder)

8. Regional Councillors' Report

None.

9. Business Arising from Notice of Motion

9.3 **Sponsorship and Advertising Asset Inventory and Valuation Report**

Regional Councillor Lee and Mayor Collier introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Council Members asked questions related to the motion. Kassandra Brownridge, Manager of Strategic Initiatives, Mayor Collier, and Regional Councillor Lee, responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: S. Collier

WHEREAS by evaluating the Town's sponsorship and advertising opportunities through a comprehensive review, the Town can maximize non-tax revenue;

AND WHEREAS the Town is home to numerous events, facilities and spaces which draw tens of thousands of residents and tourists alike;

AND WHEREAS in 2020 Ajax Council adopted a Naming Rights policy, creating a framework to leverage high value opportunities and providing staff, council and the community with clear and transparent guidance on how naming rights partnerships would be formed;

AND WHEREAS Ajax views our business community as a strong asset and partner whose goal of increasing brand awareness and driving sales can be advanced through strategic placement of advertising at Town facilities;

AND WHEREAS by leveraging strategic partnerships with the business community through sponsorship and naming right opportunities, the Town can advance projects and priorities in a more affordable and sustainable manner;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:

1. Public and Strategic Affairs staff be directed to retain an external consultant to undertake a thorough assessment of all its sponsorship and advertising assets to ensure that all assets are accurately valued and effectively utilized to maximize revenue potential; and

2. Unbudgeted funds up to $75,000, be funded from the capital contingency reserve; and

3. The Sponsorship & Advertising Asset Inventory and Valuation Report be presented to Council by October 2025.

Recorded Vote

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

9.4 **Senior Transportation Survey**

Regional Councillor Dies and Councillor Bower introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Council Members asked questions related to the motion. Regional Councillor Dies and K. Brownridge, responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: L. Bower

WHEREAS the Older Adult Operating Model Analysis, presented to Ajax Council

in October 2024, included targeted consultation with key stakeholders and reviewed transportation services only between Town recreation facilities, excluding local amenities;

AND WHEREAS on March 25, 2025, the Town hosted a Senior's Transportation Meeting where the community offered valuable input regarding transportation needs;

AND WHEREAS seniors living in Ajax organized a petition calling for more transportation options in areas where Durham Region Transit no longer offers service, receiving over 1,000 signatures in support;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:

1. Public & Strategic Affairs and Recreation & Culture be directed to undertake a comprehensive survey of seniors aged 55+ in June, Senior's Month, to assess transportation needs and barriers to transportation, and include a variety of opportunities for participation, including in-person events and both digital and paper surveys; and

2. Findings from this survey be presented at the September 8, 2025, General Government Committee meeting.

Recorded Vote

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

10. By-laws

Council Members asked questions regarding By-law number 30-2025. Nicole Cooper, Deputy Chief Administrative Officer and Mayor Collier responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That By-law numbers 29-2025 to 33-2025 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

Recorded Vote

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

11. Notice of Motion

Regional Councillor Lee provided notice that he and Councillor Bower will be bringing forward a motion to the May meeting of Council related to landlord tenant reforms.

12. New Business - Notices & Announcements

Council Members highlighted upcoming community events and matters of community interest.

14. Confirming By-Law

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: L. Bower

That By-law number 37-2025 being a by-law to confirm the proceedings of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax at its regular meeting held on April 22, 2025, be read a first, second and third time and passed.

Recorded Vote

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

15. Adjournment

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the April 22, 2025 meeting of the Council of the Town of Ajax be adjourned (3:32 p.m.)

Recorded Vote

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

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Mayor and CEO

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Clerk